

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS SCHOLASTIC CONCLAVE (IRSC) 2026

Strategic Autonomy and Global Re-alignment Exploring India's Prospects in a Multipolar World

9th , 10th & 11th September
Jadavpur University Main Campus, Kolkata

Day 1 - 9 September 2026	
10:00- 10:30	Registration
Opening Session Theme: Strategic Autonomy and Global Re-alignment - Exploring India's Prospects in a Multipolar World Venue : Triguna Sen Auditorium, Jadavpur University Main Campus Session Chair : Dr. Kamaran M K Mondal, Head of Department, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University	
10:30-12:15	Introduction and Welcome : Dr. Subhajit Naskar Coordinator, IRSC 2026 & Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University Keynote Address : <i>Strategic Autonomy in a Multipolar World: India's Evolving Global Posture</i> J. N. Choudhury (ex- IPS) Special Monitor for Criminal Justice, NHRC & Distinguished Fellow, United Service Institution of India (USI) Vote of Thanks : Dr. Shibashis Chatterjee Convenor, IRSC 2026 & Professor, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University

12:15-12:30	Coffee Break
Special Session I Theme : From Carbon Borders to Strategic Autonomy: The Political Economy of the India-EU FTA in the Quest for Viksit Bharat 2047 Venue : K.P. Basu Auditorium, Jadavpur University Main Campus Session Chair : Dr. Rajat Acharyya, Professor, Department of Economics, Jadavpur University, Kolkata	
12:30-14:30	Special Lecture : <i>Carbon and Semiconductor Autonomy in the Political Economy of India-EU FTA: Strategic Pathways to Viksit Bharat 2047</i> Prof Saibal Kar Reserve Bank of India Chair Professor of Economics, Centre for Studies in Social Sciences, Calcutta (CSSSC) Special Lecture : <i>Towards Viksit Bharat 2047: Economic Diplomacy and Strategic Autonomy</i> Prof. Manish Professor & Dean, School of International Studies (SIS), Central University of Gujarat
14:30-15:00	Lunch

Distinguished Lecture I (MEA)

Venue : K.P. Basu Auditorium, Jadavpur University Main Campus

Theme : India's Act East Policy and the continued Relevance of the Indo-Pacific Vision.

Session Chair: Dr. Kamaran M K Mondal, Head of Department, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University

15:00-15:45

Distinguished Lecture

India's Act East Policy and the continued Relevance of the Indo-Pacific Vision.

Ambassador Suchitra Durai
Former Ambassador of India to Thailand, High
Commissioner of India to Kenya &
Ambassador of India to Somalia and Eritrea

First Academic Session

Venue : Triguna Sen Auditorium, Jadavpur University Main Campus

Theme: South-South Cooperation: From Bandung to BRICS and Reclaiming Global South Agency

Chair : Swami Vedeswarupananda Maharaj, Director-in-Charge of the Vivekananda Archive, Ramakrishna Mission Institute of Culture (RMIC), Gol Park, West Bengal

16:00-17:00

Lecture:

India as the 'Vishwa Mitra': Redefining South-South Development Cooperation

Sreeram Sundar Chaulia
Professor & Dean, Jindal School of International Affairs
(JSIA) & Director General, Jindal India Institute

Day 2 - 10 September, 2026	
11:00-11:30	Registration
Second Academic Session Venue : K.P. Basu Auditorium, Jadavpur Main Campus Theme: Internal Migration and Structural Inequality: How Caste shapes Informality, and Social Exclusion. Session Chair : Dr. Kamaran M K Mondal, Head of Department, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University	
11:30-13:30	Lecture 1 : <i>Caste, Informality and Structural Inequality: Patterns of Internal Migration in India</i> Dr. Subhajit Naskar Coordinator, IRSC 2026 & Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University Lecture 2 : <i>Internal Migration and Structural Inequality</i> Dr. Ch. Satish Assistant Professor Centre for Studies in Social Sciences, Kolkata Lecture 3: <i>Social Exclusion and Labour Mobility: The Intersection of Caste and Migration</i> Dr. Abdul Matin Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University
13:30-14:00	Lunch

Third Academic Session

Venue : K.P. Basu Auditorium, Jadavpur Main Campus

Theme: Beyond SAARC: BIMSTEC and India's Strategy to Reshape Regional Governance in the Indo-Pacific.

Session Chair : Dr. Iman Kalyan Lahiri, Professor, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University

14:00-16:00

Lecture 1 :

BIMSTEC and India's Indo-Pacific Strategy: Reshaping Regional Governance

Captain S.S. Parmar

Former Indian Navy Officer & Strategic Analyst ,
Distinguished Fellow, Council for Strategic and Defense
Research (CSDR), New Delhi.

Lecture 2 :

Energy Security and Regional Cooperation in the Indo-Pacific

Dr. Vivek Mishra

Deputy Director of the Strategic Studies Programme,
Observer Research Foundation (ORF), New Delhi.

Lecture 3 :

Beyond SAARC: Institutional Innovations and India's Regional Leadership

Prof. Samir Kumar Das

Professor of Political Science & Director,
Institute of Foreign Policy Studies, University of Calcutta

Distinguished Lecture II (MEA)

Venue : K.P. Basu Auditorium, Jadavpur University Main Campus

Theme : Regional Governance in the Indo-Pacific

Session Chair: Ratan Mandal, Former Dean, ISLM, Director, School of Energy Studies, Jadavpur University

16:00-17:00

Distinguished Lecture

Regional Governance in the Indo-Pacific

Ambassador Jaideep Mazumdar,
Former Secretary (East),
India's Ministry of External Affairs
Distinguished Visiting Research Fellow,
NUS Institute of South Asian Studies (ISAS),
Singapore.

Day 3 - 11 September	
10:00-10:30	Registration
Special Session II Theme : Epistemic Swaraj and Strategic Autonomy: Reclaiming Knowledge Sovereignty in a Post-Liberal World Order Venue : K.P. Basu Auditorium, Jadavpur University Main Campus Session Chair : Prof. Debi Chatterjee (Retd.), Retired Professor, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University	
10:30-12:30	Special Lecture : <i>Sovereignty, Hierarchy and Historical Consciousness: Decolonising South Asian International Thought</i> Dr. Atul Mishra Associate Professor and Head, Department of International Relations and Governance Studies at Shiv Nadar University, Delhi-NCR. Special Lecture : <i>The Making of Indian Diplomacy: Indigenous Traditions and the Challenge to a Western-Ordered World</i> Dr. Navnita C. Behera Professor of International Relations, Department of Political Science, University of Delhi, New Delhi.
12:30-12:45	Coffee Break

Fourth Academic Session

Theme : From Source to Sea: Rethinking River and Climate Governance from the Himalaya to the Bengal Delta

Venue : K.P. Basu Auditorium, Jadavpur University Main Campus

Session Chair : Dr. Nilanjan Ghosh, Director, Observer Research Foundation (ORF), Kolkata

12:45-14:30

Lecture 1 :

Sundarbans and Climate Governance: Local Ecological Knowledge in a Changing Climate

Dr. Anamitra Anurag Danda,
Director, Sundarbans Programme at WWF-India & Senior Visiting Fellow with the Energy and Climate Change Programme at the Observer Research Foundation

Lecture 2 :

Sediment Starvation and Rising Seas: The Physical Unmaking of the Sundarbans Delta and Its Implications for Upstream River Governance

Dr. Sugata Hazra
Professor of Coastal Zone Management and the former Director of the School of Oceanographic Studies, Jadavpur University, Kolkata.

Fifth Academic Session (Parallel Session)

Theme : Bridging the Hiatus of History: India's Maritime Civilisational Networks, the Bay of Bengal Region, and the Strategic Evolution of India's Eastward Policy

Venue : IR Seminar Hall, Jadavpur University

Session Chair : Dr. Ishani Naskar, Professor, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University

12:45-14:30

Lecture 1 :

Bay of Bengal Region and the Strategic Evolution of India's Act East Policy

Dr. Anindya Jyoti Majumdar
Professor, Department of International Relations,
Jadavpur University

	Lecture 2 : <i>The Evolution of India's Practice of Strategic Autonomy: From Non-Alignment to Multi-Alignment</i> Dr. Monish Tourangbam Fellow and Senior Research Consultant, Chintan Research Foundation, Honorary Director, Kalinga Institute of Indo-Pacific Studies
14:30-15:00	Lunch
Sixth Academic Session Theme: India's Maritime Strategy and the Quest for Regional Primacy in the Indian Ocean Venue : IR Seminar Hall, Jadavpur Main Campus Session Chair : Prof. Rajkumar Kothari, Professor and Head of the Department of Political Science at Diamond Harbour Women's University (DHWU) & Former Vice-Chancellor, Sanskrit College and University	
15:00-16:30	Lecture 1: <i>India's Maritime Strategy: Balancing Regional Primacy and Multipolar Realities</i> Colonel (Dr.) Guru Saday Batabyal Military Veteran, Author and Visiting Faculty, Army War College, Mhow, Madhya Pradesh. Lecture 2 : <i>Maritime Security and Regional Primacy in the Indian Ocean: Challenges and Prospects</i> Dr. Sreeradha Dutta Professor, Jindal School of International Affairs (JSIA), O.P. Jindal Global University, Sonipat
16:30-17:00	Coffee Break

Closing Session

Venue : K.P. Basu Auditorium, Jadavpur Main Campus

Session Chair : Dr. Kamaran M K Mondal, Head of Department, Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University

17:00-19:00

Valedictory Address :

Prof. Rakhahari Chatterjee,
Honorary Distinguished Fellow,
Observer Research Foundation (ORF), Kolkata

IRSC Key Outcomes :

Dr. Shibashis Chatterjee,
Convenor, IRSC 2026 & Professor,
Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University

Vote of Thanks :

Dr. Subhajit Naskar,
Coordinator, IRSC 2026 & Assistant Professor,
Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University